



Demonstrators carry a banner reading *Solidarność*, or "Solidarity," the name of the first noncommunist Polish trade union.

FORMER ACTOR RONALD REAGAN BECAME THE 40TH PRESIDENT

of the US on January 20. Two months later he survived an assassination attempt by **John Hinckley**, who was obsessed with actress Jodie Foster, and believed an assassination of the president would impress her.

Pope John Paul II survived being **shot four times** on May 13 as he travelled through crowds in his "popemobile" in St. Peter's Square, Rome. Police arrested Mehmet Ali Hagca, a Turkish citizen, who was sentenced to life imprisonment in July.

A **state of emergency** was declared in **Egypt** after **President Anwar Sadat** was assassinated at a military parade. A group calling itself the **Independent Organization for the Liberation of Egypt** said it carried out the attack. Vice-President Hosni Mubarak succeeded President Sadat as head of state.



“ IF WE RESIGN TODAY WE WILL BURY OUR HOPES FOR FREEDOM FOR MANY YEARS TO COME. SEVERAL THOUSAND PEOPLE CANNOT OVERCOME TEN MILLION. ”

Solidarity, trade union, message to the people of Poland, December 1981

On January 20, **Iran** finally agreed to **release 52 American hostages**, who had been held for 444 days. This followed a guarantee from the US that it would release Iranian assets that had been frozen in American banks since the US embassy was seized in Tehran.

Iran also saw renewed political terrorism this year. The **Mujahidin**, a group of muslim fighters, mounted waves of **bombings and assassinations**. In August, both the new president **Ali Rajai** and the prime minister **Javad Bahonar** were killed. In October,

Ali Khamenei was elected president in a landslide victory.

Spain was in turmoil after an attempted **right wing coup**, led by Lieutenant Colonel Antonio Tejero Molina (b. 1932), who stormed

Spanish coup
Colonel Antonio Tejero stormed the Spanish parliament, firing shots into the air as he announced a military coup. The coup collapsed within hours.

the Spanish parliament along with 200 soldiers. Armed forces put down the coup on February 23.

Israel shocked the world by blowing up a **nuclear plant** near Baghdad, **Iraq**, on June 7. They claimed it had the capability of making nuclear weapons to destroy Israel – Iraq denied this.

In the face of union protests, the **Polish government** declared a **state of emergency** on December 13, and placed leaders of the **Solidarity** trade union under arrest. In response, members of Solidarity called for a **national strike** (see 1982).

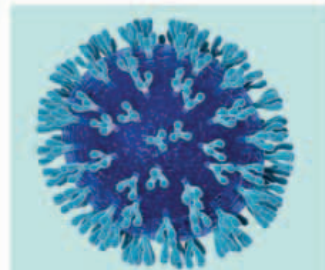
Brixton, south London, erupted into **riots** on April 11 after a black man was arrested by police. The violence spread to other cities where there had been unrest due to poor relations between black communities and the police.

Columbia became the first **shuttle** to fly into space on April 12. The maiden flight was piloted by veteran US astronauts **John Young** (b. 1930) and **Robert Crippen** (b. 1937), and heralded a new era in space exploration.

Bob Marley (b. 1945), the international face of reggae music, died of cancer on May 11.

He was 36 years old. Bob Marley and the Wailers was the world's most recognized **reggae band**.

AIDS (see panel, below) came to the fore in June after the deaths of five men in Los Angeles. Previously, no cases had been reported outside the gay community; it became clear that the disease affected other groups. The unknown condition came to be named **Acquired Immune Deficiency Syndrome** (AIDS).



HIV VIRUS

HIV is a virus that causes Acquired Immune Deficiency Syndrome (AIDS), a disease of the immune system. The HIV virus was discovered in May 1983 by doctors at the Pasteur Institute in France. The isolation of the HIV virus made it possible to develop drugs that could dramatically extend the life expectancy of those with AIDS, although no vaccine has yet been found. At least 28 million people worldwide have died from the disease; Africa has been the worst affected area.



The frigate *HMS Antelope* exploded on May 23, during the Falklands War.

ARGENTINA INVADED THE BRITISH TERRITORY of the Falkland Islands

in the South Atlantic on April 2. The sovereignty of the islands had long been disputed. British prime minister **Margaret Thatcher** (b. 1925) sent a naval task force to liberate the islands. The subsequent conflict cost the lives of hundreds of Argentine and British servicemen, many of them through **missile attacks on navy warships**. The conflict ended on June 14, when the commander of the Argentine garrison at **Port Stanley** surrendered to the British.

Iran launched **Operation Udeniable Victory** in March, as part of its war against Iraq (see 1980). This marked a major turning point, and Iran forced the Iraqis to retreat. Within a week, Iran succeeded in destroying a large

